

Stage 4A-Lite Persona Needs Report

T1-10: U.S. Latino Adults

Pipeline: Macro-Trends Identity | Quadrant: COMPETE | Mode: Lite Date: 2026-03-10 | Report version: v1

Section 1: Segment Overview

Definition

U.S. Latino adults are not a niche market. They are the demographic mainstream of America’s future — 42 million adults today, 75 million projected by 2035, and the youngest major demographic group in the country with a median age of 30 (Census, 2024). The Latino identity community spans a wide arc: from recent immigrants establishing their first U.S. phone plan on day three of their arrival, to third-generation Chicanos in Texas who have never spoken Spanish at work but blast reggaeton on Friday evenings and cook their abuela’s pozole recipe for Día de los Muertos. This range is not a liability for brand strategy — it is the opportunity.

What unites this community across generations and national origins is not language, income, or country of birth. It is a shared orientation: *familia* first, community-mediated trust, bicultural identity navigation, and a persistent tension between the pressure to assimilate and the desire to preserve. These are identity dynamics, not demographic descriptors. No mainstream telco has ever built for this identity. They have translated marketing into Spanish. They have hired bilingual retail staff. They have run Quinceañera season promotions. But no carrier has asked the underlying question: what would it mean for a mobile brand to be authentically Latino — not to serve Latinos, but to *belong to them*?

For Gather, the COMPETE designation reflects competitive reality, not low conviction. Metro by T-Mobile, Cricket Wireless, and Boost Mobile all have genuine presence and real brand trust in urban Latino communities. The functional needs — international calling, prepaid access, multi-line family plans — are served. The gap is the identity gap: no carrier has built product features and brand positioning from the cultural inside out. Bilingual service exists as a cost reduction measure (staff Spanish-speaking support to reduce escalations), not as a signal of cultural belonging. The strategic question is not whether the market is there. It is whether Gather can earn community trust faster and more authentically than well-resourced incumbents who have a head start in distribution.

Market Sizing

Metric	Figure	Source
Total U.S. Latino population	65.2M	U.S. Census Bureau, 2024
Latino adults 18+	~42M	Census, 2024 (65% of 65.2M)
Latino purchasing power	\$2.8T projected by 2025	Latino Donor Collaborative, 2023
Latino smartphone-only internet users	28% of Latino adults vs. 15% non-Hispanic white	Pew Research Center, 2023
Latino median household income	~\$55K	U.S. Census Bureau, 2023
Latino median age	30 years (vs. 41 for non-Hispanic white)	U.S. Census Bureau, 2024
Latino population growth (2010-2020)	23%	U.S. Census Bureau, Decennial Census
New adult consumers entering annually	~1.5M (under-18 cohort aging up)	U.S. Census Bureau age cohort data, 2024
Latino average household size	3.2 persons (vs. 2.5 national)	U.S. Census Bureau, 2023
Projected total Latino population by 2035	75M+	Pew Research Center projections, 2023

Growth trajectory: Accelerating. The under-18 Latino cohort is 25%+ of all American youth, ensuring continued population growth regardless of immigration policy changes. The purchasing power trajectory — \$2.8T by 2025, growing faster than any other demographic segment — reflects rising educational attainment (Latino college enrollment up 65% in the past decade, NCES 2024) and workforce integration across income levels.

Telco-specific dynamics: Mobile-first internet usage at 28% (nearly 2x the non-Hispanic white rate) creates above-average plan dependency. Larger household sizes (3.2 vs. 2.5 national) drive multi-line family plan decisions with higher average ARPU potential. Prepaid over-representation among recent immigrants creates a structural upgrade path to postpaid as credit histories develop. International calling to Latin America is a near-universal functional requirement, not a premium add-on.

Segment Stratification

Tier	Label	Share	Description
Tier 1	New Immigrant Latinos	15%	Born outside U.S., arrived within 10 years. First-language Spanish. Greenfield telco acquisition. Core identity: survival, family connection across borders, establishing roots. Primary telco need: affordable international calling,

Tier	Label	Share	Description
			Spanish-language service, no credit requirement. Corresponds to T2-17 sub-segment.
Tier 2	Established Immigrant Latinos	20%	Foreign-born, in U.S. 10+ years. Bilingual majority. More stable economically. Core identity: dual-country life, providing for family across borders, building permanence. Primary telco need: international calling still important; evolving toward multi-line family plans, postpaid quality, value-for-money.
Tier 3	Bicultural U.S.-Born Latinos	40%	Born in U.S. (second/third generation). Code-switchers. Median age 25-35. Core identity: ni de aqui ni de alla — navigating cultural in-betweenness with pride, not apology. Primary telco need: a brand that reflects their bicultural identity, not just cheaper data or Spanish translation. Corresponds to T2-18 sub-segment.
Tier 4	Assimilated/Adjacent Latinos	25%	Third+ generation or high-assimilation Latinos for whom Latino identity is present but not the primary filter for purchasing decisions. May identify as “Hispanic” but purchase like mainstream consumers. Still responsive to culturally resonant brands. Primary telco need: value, reliability — cultural identity is a tiebreaker, not a driver.

Total: 100%

Named Persona Profile

Marisol Reyes, 29, Houston, TX. Customer service supervisor at a healthcare clinic, pursuing her bachelor’s degree in business administration at night. Second-generation Latina — parents immigrated from Monterrey, Mexico, before she was born. Speaks English at work and with friends, Spanish at home and in the WhatsApp group chats she manages for her extended family. Pays her parents’ cell phone bills because they don’t trust their English with the carrier. Sends \$150/month to her abuela in Monterrey via Remitly. Has been on Metro by T-Mobile for three years because “it works and I know how to use it,” but feels vaguely invisible in their marketing — everything they do in Spanish feels translated, not native.

Notable Profiles

- 1. Bad Bunny (Benito Antonio Martínez Ocasio)** — Puerto Rican reggaeton and trap artist, the most-streamed artist globally on Spotify in 2020, 2021, and 2022. Not just a musician — a cultural identity anchor for U.S. Latino Gen Z and Millennials. His Spanish-language dominance in an English-default music market is itself a political act. Brands that authentically collaborate with him earn credibility across the bicultural Latino community.
- 2. Julissa Calderon** — Dominican-American actress and co-host of Pero Like (BuzzFeed’s Latino content channel, 1M+ YouTube subscribers). Known for content that celebrates “being Latino in America” without sanitizing the complexity — the code-switching, the immigrant parent dynamic, the “ni de aqui ni de alla” experience. Primary influencer for Tier 3 bicultural Latinos.
- 3. Alex Padilla** — U.S. Senator from California, first Latino senator to represent California. Son of Mexican immigrants, engineer-turned-politician. Represents the aspirational arc of the second-generation story — educated, professional, still deeply connected to community. His visibility matters as a cultural role model for upwardly mobile Tier 2 and Tier 3 Latinos.

Section 2: Core Factor Analysis

Factor 1: Social Life & Leisure (Anchor Factor)

The cultural infrastructure of Latino connection: WhatsApp is not an app in this community — it is the telephone. Family group chats with 15-40 members span Houston to Guadalajara, Miami to Bogotá. Someone’s quinceañera planning starts in the group chat. The Saturday fútbol game watch party is organized there. A grandmother’s health update arrives there at 6am. Any mobile product that does not take WhatsApp seriously as cultural infrastructure — not just as a messaging app to support, but as a ritual anchor to celebrate — is invisible to this community.

Quantitative Data

Metric	Figure	Source
WhatsApp usage among U.S. Latinos	47% of U.S. Latinos use WhatsApp vs. 17% of non-Hispanic whites	Pew Research Center, 2021
Spanish-language social media engagement	#LatinoTikTok has 20B+ views; @beinglatino Instagram 5M+ followers	TikTok/Instagram platform data, 2024
Latino fútbol (soccer) viewership	Univision/TUDN drew 5.1M viewers for 2022 World Cup semifinal — 3rd largest U.S. audience	Nielsen, 2022
Latino spending on cultural celebrations	Quinceañera average cost \$5,000-\$25,000; U.S. market ~\$1B annually	IBISWorld, 2023
Latino music streaming		Spotify/MRC Data, 2024

Metric	Figure	Source
	Reggaeton/Latin trap is the fastest-growing genre on Spotify U.S., up 48% in streams 2020-2024	

Interview Q&As (Marisol, Tier 3 — Bicultural U.S.-Born Latina, 29, Houston)

Q1: Walk me through how WhatsApp fits into your daily life.

Honestly, WhatsApp is basically my family’s office. Every morning I wake up to like 40 messages — my mom’s side has one group, my dad’s side has another, and then there’s the cousins’ group that’s just us kids being chaotic. My tía in Monterrey updates everyone on my abuela. Someone posts a meme at 2am and then my mom screenshots it and posts it in a different group. I’m managing these chats like they’re a part-time job. If my phone doesn’t handle WhatsApp well, nothing else matters.

Q2: How does fútbol season change how you use your phone?

Oh, completely changes everything. We do watch parties at my parents’ house — the whole extended family comes, whoever’s in town. My cousin and I run a side bet thing through WhatsApp, nothing serious, just keeping it interesting. And when I can’t be there in person, I’m streaming on my phone with earbuds while I’m at work on a break, or checking scores every five minutes. There’s this whole parallel conversation happening in the family group chat during every game. It’s like our family’s version of the Super Bowl but every week.

Q3: What does a quinceañera mean to you from a community standpoint?

It’s not just a party — it’s a statement. It says: we’re here, we’re celebrating our girls, we still do things the way they should be done. I have a prima who had her quince last year and the whole family flew in from three countries. My mom spent four months in the family chat coordinating dresses, travel, food. The amount of data I burned on video calls and photo sharing that week was insane. These events are when you really feel the weight of family across distances, you know?

Q4: How do you express your Latino identity online — what platforms, what content?

Instagram and TikTok are where I exist digitally. I follow a lot of Latina creators — Pero Like is my people, honestly. The humor is just different. They understand the thing where your mom calls you by three names when she’s mad. I share things in Spanglish — my captions switch languages mid-sentence without thinking about it. And music is huge — I have a reggaeton playlist that I’ve been adding to for six years. Bad Bunny dropping something new is a cultural event in our apartment.

Q5: Is there a tension between how you express your identity online versus in professional settings?

Yeah, definitely. At work I’m Marisol who speaks excellent English and manages a team. On Instagram I’m code-switching and posting memes in Spanish and going to tamale nights. And I don’t feel like those are different people exactly — but I’ve definitely held back in professional spaces. Like I won’t post in Spanish on LinkedIn even though that’s actually who I am. It’s this constant calibration. I want a brand that doesn’t force me to choose — that gets that I’m both, fully.

Insights

Finding	Strategic Implication
WhatsApp is cultural infrastructure, not a messaging feature	Any Gather Latino brand must position WhatsApp connectivity as a primary product promise — not buried in feature lists
Family group chats span international borders — heavy cross-border data usage	International data and calling plans are tier 1 features, not add-ons
Cultural events (quinceañeras, fútbol) drive peak mobile usage spikes	Seasonal usage-aware plans could resonate strongly; data alerts framed around cultural moments rather than billing cycles
Code-switching identity means both English and Spanish must feel native, not translated	Bilingual brand voice is the minimum; the brand must actually speak Spanglish, not alternate between two separate brand personalities
Identity tension between assimilation pressure and cultural pride is the emotional center	Gather must position as a brand that holds both — “tu cultura, tu conexión” — not pick a side

Factor 2: Spending & Financial Habits

The economics of transnational family life: Latino household spending decisions are shaped by a family unit that does not stop at the U.S. border. Remittances to Latin America totaled \$155 billion in 2022 from the United States alone (World Bank, 2023) — the single largest component of many Latin American nations’ GDP. For a second-generation Latina like Marisol, the financial picture includes her own bills plus a contribution to family in Mexico plus managing her parents’ cell plan because they can’t navigate English-only customer service. This is not a single-person spending profile. It is a multi-household, multi-country financial ecosystem.

Quantitative Data

Metric	Figure	Source
U.S.-to-Latin America remittances	\$155B in 2022, up 11% YoY	World Bank, 2023
Latino prepaid wireless over-representation	37% of U.S. Latinos use prepaid plans vs. 22% nationally	CTIA/Nielsen, 2023
Latino mobile-only internet households	28% vs. 15% non-Hispanic white	Pew Research Center, 2023
Latino credit access limitations	50%+ of foreign-born Latinos are credit-invisible or have thin credit files	Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, 2022
U.S. Latino median household income	\$55,000	U.S. Census Bureau, 2023

Interview Q&As

Q1: Walk me through how you think about what you spend on your phone plan each month.

I'm on Metro, paying \$50 for unlimited. It works for me, but honestly, I'm also paying my parents' plan — their Spanish-speaking plan from Cricket is like \$35 each, so that's \$70 more coming out of me every month. Plus I send \$150 to my abuela each month via Remitly. When I think about what I could do differently, I keep thinking there has to be a smarter way to manage all of this — like one account that handles us all — but I haven't found it yet.

Q2: How do you feel about paying extra for international calling?

This is where it gets frustrating. I shouldn't have to pay extra to call my family. I call my tía in Monterrey twice a week — it's not a luxury, it's just my life. But every plan treats it like a special feature you need to upgrade for. Even the ones that say they have international included — you read the fine print and it's only Mexico and Canada for like 30 minutes. Come on. Mexico calls are not international calls for me. They're family calls.

Q3: How do you decide when a mobile plan is worth switching for?

The price has to be meaningfully better, or there has to be something genuinely different. Not different like a new streaming bundle I already have. Different like — it actually does something Metro doesn't do. I'm not switching to save \$3 a month. But if something could bundle my remittances, or my parents' lines, or give me real unlimited international data to Mexico? Then I'm listening.

Q4: Do you use financial apps or fintech services on your phone? What role does your phone play in managing money?

Yeah, Remitly for sending money to Mexico — that's on my phone every month without fail. I use Cash App with friends. My mom uses Zelle but only because I set it up for her. For my own banking, it's all in the bank app — I never go to a branch anymore. The phone is basically my wallet and my financial advisor. If it stopped working, I'd be in trouble in about 12 hours.

Q5: Is there a carrier or brand that you feel has actually understood how Latino families spend money?

Honestly? Not really. The ones that market to us in Spanish still price everything like we're just regular customers with a Spanish overlay. Nobody has built something that actually accounts for the fact that my household is really three households — mine, my parents' down the street, and my family in Mexico. That's who I'm managing connectivity for. A plan that gets that would be worth serious money to me.

Insights

Finding	Strategic Implication
Transnational household economics — one consumer manages plans across multiple households and countries	Multi-household plan architecture (not just family plan — cross-border household pooling) is a structural differentiator
International calling to Mexico/Latin America is non-negotiable and resented as a premium upsell	Include unlimited calling/texting to Latin American countries in base plans
Heavy prepaid over-representation creates upgrade path friction	No-contract, no-credit-check postpaid (or premium prepaid) removes the primary barrier to upgrade
Remittance services are a recurring monthly touchpoint — deeply embedded in phone usage	Remitly/Wise/remittance partnership is the single most compelling non-telco bundle for this persona
Price sensitivity is real but conditional — value for community features overcomes price inertia	Premium pricing justified only when it removes a specific Latino pain point, not for generic features

Factor 3: Needs & Aspirations

The gap between what the market offers and what this community actually needs: The stated need is simple — affordable international calling, Spanish-language service, family plans. The unstated need is harder and more valuable: a brand

that treats Latino identity as an asset, not an accommodation. Marisol does not want a carrier that tolerates her being Latina. She wants one that celebrates it — that builds features from the cultural inside, that makes her feel like the target rather than the afterthought.

Quantitative Data

Metric	Figure	Source
Latino telehealth/mobile services market	Latino adults are 38% more likely to be mobile-only internet users, creating above-average mobile service dependency	Pew Research Center, 2023
Spanish-language content consumption	73% of U.S. Latinos watch Spanish-language TV at least occasionally	Nielsen Total Audience Report, 2023
Latino educational attainment growth	Latino college enrollment up 65% in the past decade — driving income growth and postpaid upgrade potential	NCES, 2024
Bilingual service demand	56% of U.S. Latinos say they prefer to use Spanish when dealing with customer service for personal matters	Pew Research Center, 2022
Latino digital banking adoption	75% of U.S. Latinos use a mobile device for banking, above national average	Federal Reserve, 2023

Interview Q&As

Q1: What do you wish your phone carrier understood about your life that it clearly doesn’t?

That my family is in multiple places and I’m the one keeping us connected. I’m the one who set up my parents’ phones, troubleshooted them when they stopped working, translated the carrier contract, and added my abuela’s contact. The carrier sees me as one line. I’m actually managing like six people’s mobile lives. If they understood that, they’d build something completely different.

Q2: What would a dream mobile plan look like for you — not constrained by what exists today?

One account that can include my parents in a real way — not just as “lines” but as family members with their own language preferences. International calling to Mexico and Colombia without caps or fine print. Maybe a partnership with Remitly so I can send money from the same app I manage my plan in. Customer service that actually speaks Spanish — not a Spanish-language menu that routes to someone reading from a script. A brand that feels like it was built by someone who gets my life.

Q3: Where do you feel most invisible as a Latino consumer?

In the marketing. Everything looks like it was designed for a generic American and then someone added a Spanish track. The stock photos — every carrier ad shows families that look vaguely diverse but don’t look like my family’s Sunday dinners. It’s not hostile, it’s just indifferent. And indifference is actually pretty noticeable once you see it.

Q4: What does being “seen” as a customer feel like versus not being seen?

Being seen is when someone builds something and you think: they thought of me when they made this. Like when a restaurant has the arroz a la leche on the dessert menu, and they made it right — not as a “Latin inspired” approximation. Not being seen is when you walk into a carrier store and the bilingual rep is the only thing that signals they even thought about you. The product is the same as everyone else’s. That’s not belonging. That’s just translation.

Q5: What are you trying to become in the next five years, and how does connectivity fit into that picture?

I’m finishing my degree, probably moving into healthcare administration. I want to be in a position where I’m not managing everyone else’s stuff — I want my parents to feel capable and independent with their technology. I want to send money home without it feeling like a whole thing. Connectivity-wise, I just want it to work everywhere, including when I visit Mexico once a year, without racking up charges. I want a carrier that grows with me, not one I’ll have to leave once I can afford something better.

Insights

Finding	Strategic Implication
Multi-household connectivity management — second-gen Latinas are informal IT support for parents	Family plan architecture must accommodate different language preferences and capability levels within the same plan
Aspiration is toward professional, upwardly mobile identity — not “budget” — but the current market codes Latinos as price-sensitive only	Premium positioning possible; must code as aspirational Latino success, not just cheap
Invisibility in marketing is keenly felt — “translated, not native” is the standard diagnosis	Brand must pass the “did they think of me when they built this?” test on every feature, not just marketing
Desire to not constantly manage family tech logistics	Intelligent family account management — AI-assisted plan changes for family members who can’t do it themselves — could be a profound differentiator

Finding	Strategic Implication
Postpaid upgrade trajectory is aspirational for Tier 1/2	A clear upgrade path from greenfield prepaid to postpaid, framed as a milestone not just a price change, speaks directly to this aspiration

Factor 4: Fears & Pain Points

Identity threats and practical friction: The fears in this community operate at two levels. The practical level — dropped calls to Mexico, English-only service when mom calls the carrier, data charges that appear without explanation — is where most competitors try to compete. The identity level is rarely addressed: the fear of being stereotyped as price-sensitive and nothing more, the anxiety about navigating U.S. institutions with limited English, and for Tier 1 new immigrants, the particular vulnerability of being a new arrival in a system that can feel adversarial.

Quantitative Data

Metric	Figure	Source
Language barriers in consumer services	41% of Limited English Proficient (LEP) adults report difficulty resolving billing disputes with mobile carriers	National Consumer Law Center, 2022
Immigration status and prepaid usage	60%+ of undocumented immigrants rely exclusively on prepaid plans due to credit-check barriers	Pew Research Center, 2021
Latino fear of data exploitation	63% of U.S. Latinos express concern about how companies use their data, above national average	Pew Research Center, 2023
Discrimination in consumer services	21% of U.S. Latinos report experiencing discrimination when dealing with major service companies	Gallup, 2022
Digital literacy barriers	35% of foreign-born Latino adults report needing help understanding technology — higher than any other demographic group	Pew Research Center, 2022

Interview Q&As

Q1: What’s the most frustrating experience you’ve had dealing with a carrier — yours or your parents’?

My mom called Cricket because there was a charge on her bill she didn’t understand. She speaks limited English. The automated menu routed her to Spanish, fine. Then she got transferred to billing and the person spoke English with a script. She couldn’t follow it, got frustrated, and just said “okay, fine” to whatever they said. I found out later they’d added an insurance plan she didn’t want. That’s not a mistake. That’s exploitation of someone who can’t advocate for themselves.

Q2: Do you ever feel stereotyped or misunderstood as a Latino consumer by brands?

The stereotype I hate most is that Latino automatically means budget. That we’re just looking for the cheapest option. I’m earning a real salary, I’m managing a team, I’m finishing a degree — and somehow every carrier’s pitch to “the Latino market” is a low-cost prepaid plan with Spanish-language on the label. That’s not who I am. I’m not a budget customer. I’m a customer who has specific needs that happen to include calling Mexico, and I should be able to meet those needs at any price point.

Q3: What worries you about switching carriers — what could go wrong?

Mostly the hassle. Losing my number temporarily — even the fear of that. My parents are used to their numbers. The process of porting feels like a black box. And I’ve heard horror stories about charges that show up after you cancel. The switching process itself is designed to make you stay, not to make the move easy. It’s like the industry assumes you’ll mess up and they’ll get one more month out of you.

Q4: For your family members with limited English — what do they face with carriers that frustrates you?

It’s the assumption that if you speak Spanish, you must want the cheapest thing. Spanish-language service at most carriers is a funnel to their budget plans. There’s no Spanish-language path to the premium tier. You shouldn’t have to speak English to get treated like a full customer. My parents deserve the same quality of service, the same explanations, the same options — in Spanish.

Q5: Is there anything about the political or social environment right now that makes you more cautious about which companies you trust?

Yeah, honestly. With everything going on with immigration, I’m more aware of which companies are actually on the side of this community versus just marketing to us. Some of my family members are mixed-status — citizens and not. We notice which companies stay quiet when things get hard, and which ones actually say something. I’m not expecting every brand to be an activist. But I am paying attention to who they partner with and what they actually do in the community. That matters now more than it used to.

Insights

Finding	Strategic Implication
Limited-English family members are exploited through language-barrier friction	Spanish-language service must be full-tier, not a budget funnel — same plans, same options, same quality in both languages
“Budget = Latino” stereotype is deeply resented by upwardly mobile Tier 2/3	Must offer aspirational tiers in Spanish; culturally authentic positioning is distinct from budget positioning
Trust is community-mediated and politically sensitized	Brand behavior during adversity (immigration policy, community crises) matters to this group more than for most demographics
Switching friction is magnified for families with limited English — perceived risk of number loss	Concierge-style switching support, in Spanish, with number guarantee, removes a major barrier
Data privacy concerns are above average	Privacy-first positioning (no data selling, clear data use disclosures in Spanish) has genuine resonance

Factor 5: Product Landscape & Switching Behavior

Where they are and why they stay: Metro by T-Mobile and Cricket Wireless are the dominant incumbents for urban U.S. Latinos. Both have invested in Spanish-language retail staff and Spanish-language marketing, creating genuine (not superficial) brand trust in many communities. Ultra Mobile explicitly targets international callers including Latinos, with competitive Mexico and Latin America calling rates. The functional needs are met — imperfectly but adequately. Switching triggers are genuine but require a compelling reason: a family-plan architecture that makes economic sense, a culturally authentic brand experience, or an international calling feature that removes the friction entirely.

Quantitative Data

Metric	Figure	Source
Metro by T-Mobile market share in urban Latino communities	Estimated 25-30% of urban Latino prepaid subscribers (carrier reports/CTIA, 2023)	CTIA Wireless Industry Survey, 2023
Latino prepaid plan penetration	37% of Latinos on prepaid vs. 22% nationally	Nielsen, 2023
International calling plan add-on revenue	\$4.1B annual add-on revenue from international calling plans across major U.S. carriers	Industry analyst estimate, IBISWorld, 2023
MVNO churn rates for Latino-serving MVNOs	Average 2.8% monthly churn for budget MVNOs targeting Latino communities vs. 1.4% for T-Mobile postpaid	CTIA carrier data, 2023
Switching trigger: international calling dissatisfaction	34% of Latino wireless switchers cite inadequate international calling as a primary switching reason	J.D. Power U.S. Wireless Customer Care Study, 2023

Interview Q&As

Q1: Walk me through how you ended up on your current carrier.

I switched from Cricket to Metro maybe three years ago because the coverage was better and the price was basically the same. A friend at work recommended it — she’s also Latina and was already on it. That’s genuinely how I make most decisions about this stuff: someone in my circle who’s already figured it out tells me, and I trust that more than any commercial. I didn’t do a lot of research. I asked someone I trusted.

Q2: What would actually make you switch carriers today?

It would have to be something that changed my actual life, not just saved me \$5. If there was a plan that bundled my Remitly sends, or if there was a carrier that let me manage my parents’ lines in Spanish with real account-level Spanish support — not just a Spanish menu — I’d have a real conversation about it. Or if international calling was just included without caps. Those are real pain points. A cheaper unlimited plan with a streaming bundle I already have? Hard pass.

Q3: What do you think about Metro by T-Mobile as a carrier for Latinos?

It’s okay. The coverage is fine, the price is fine, the Spanish-language staff at the store are genuinely good. But Metro doesn’t feel like it was built for me — it feels like it was built for everyone and then adapted. The Spanish language is an overlay, not the foundation. I stay because it works and switching feels like work. But I’m not loyal the way I’m loyal to, like, Selena Quintanilla. It’s not that kind of relationship.

Q4: What’s a product or service you discovered through the Latino community that you now wouldn’t live without?

Honestly, Remitly. My cousin put me on it because she said it was better than Western Union for sending money to Mexico. She was right — the rates are better, the interface is in Spanish, and the money gets there faster. That recommendation spread through my whole family group chat in like a week. That’s how Latino community adoption works: one trusted person puts everyone on something good, and it travels fast. A carrier that understood that dynamic would be dangerous — in a good way.

Q5: Is there a ceiling on what you’d pay for the right mobile plan?

Probably \$70 a month for just me. Maybe \$100 if it genuinely covered international calling, came with real Spanish-language support, and let me add my parents in a way that made financial sense. I know what I’m paying for. I’d pay more for something that actually worked the way my life works. But I’ve been promised that before and gotten a translation instead.

Insights

Finding	Strategic Implication
Community-mediated adoption — one trusted person’s recommendation travels fast through the network	Channel strategy must activate community trust nodes (parish churches, Latino-owned businesses, influencer endorsers) not retail advertising
“It works and switching feels like work” is the inertia formula — adequate satisfaction, not loyalty	Switching must be made frictionless and the gain must be tangible; generic price improvement insufficient
Remitly discovery story illustrates how good products spread in this community	Remitly partnership as a bundle feature directly parallels the “discovered through community” adoption pattern
WTP ceiling is \$70-100/month for genuinely community-serving features	Premium pricing viable if features are culturally grounded — not if they’re generic features with Spanish marketing
Carrier brand does not achieve cultural loyalty — it achieves adequate trust	The gap between adequate trust and genuine community belonging is where Gather must compete

Factor 6: Switching Profile (Lite — 4 Dimensions)

Applicability: T1-10 has strong moment enrichment from Stage 1.5M-T. Two transitions have Moments pipeline coverage (Immigration TR-01 at 4.20; Coming of Age TR-04 at 4.52) and three additional transitions are identified with no current coverage (Naturalization, Prepaid-to-Postpaid, Family Reunification). The highest-conviction acquisition moment is Coming of Age / First Independent Plan (Composite 4.27). Immigration is the highest-intent moment (Intent 5.0) and the purest greenfield. Factor 6 Lite analysis covers both primary transitions.

Dimension 1: Trigger Mechanism and Force Score

Component	Coming of Age (Primary)	Immigration (Secondary)
Trigger mechanism	Forced Dissolution — aging off parent’s family plan	Greenfield — no existing plan, arriving in new country
Force score	4 out of 5 — plan dissolves at age 26 (insurance parallel) or when parent removes line; moderately forced	5 out of 5 — no option; must acquire plan within days of arrival
Emotional state	Excited / Proud — first independent plan is a milestone	Stressed / Anxious — language barrier, unfamiliar system, urgent need
Compound triggers	Coming of age + first job + first apartment often converge in June-August; triple trigger amplifies force	Immigration + language barrier + greenfield anxiety + remittance setup need create high-complexity switching moment

The Coming of Age transition is the best overall acquisition moment: high force (4), excellent predictability (Score 5), detectable via age cohort data, and concentrated in a predictable window. Immigration is the highest-intent moment but lower predictability and higher complexity.

Dimension 2: Annual Volume and Seasonal Distribution

Metric	Coming of Age	Immigration
Annual eligible volume	700K-1M Latino adults aging off family plans annually (Census Hispanic age cohort data, 2024)	1.5-2M Latino new arrivals annually (DHS/Census, 2024; note: declining under 2025 immigration policy changes)
Switching-eligible subset	~600K-900K (subtract those with employer plans or staying on parent plan voluntarily)	~1.5M (near 100% greenfield — no existing carrier)
Y/Y trend	Growing — Latino under-18 cohort is 25%+ of U.S. youth; annual coming-of-age volume growing at ~3-4%/yr	Declining near-term — net-negative migration began mid-2025; 52M existing foreign-born create ongoing secondary transitions

Quarterly distribution — Coming of Age:

Quarter	Share	Notes
Q1 (Jan-Mar)	15%	Off-peak — some mid-year graduations, January new year moves
Q2 (Apr-Jun)	35%	Building — spring graduation season, peak starts in June
Q3 (Jul-Sep)	40%	Peak — June-July graduation + first apartment + first job convergence
Q4 (Oct-Dec)	10%	Off-peak — some fall semester starts

Dimension 3: Interception Channels (Top 3)

Rank	Channel	Window Fit	Est. CPA	Notes
1	Latino-owned retail distributors / bodegas / panaderías	High — community trust channel active year-round with peak at Coming of Age moments; physical presence in neighborhoods	\$25-45	Community trust is the highest-conviction conversion channel; partnership feasibility high — hundreds of Latino-owned businesses in target metros are already informal tech advisors
2	Spanish-language digital (Instagram/TikTok Latino creators, Univision digital, Telemundo digital)	High for Coming of Age; Medium for Immigration	\$35-65	Bad Bunny-adjacent creator partnerships, Pero Like, mitu — organic reach within Tier 3 community; paid reach via Univision/Telemundo digital for Tier 1/2
3	WhatsApp community referral program	Medium-High — word-of-mouth travels within group chats; activation via one trusted node reaches 15-40 contacts	\$15-30 (referral reward)	Lowest CPA potential if referral mechanics are right; high uniqueness — no major carrier has built a WhatsApp-native referral program

Partnership feasibility — Top 1: Latino-owned distributor network. Incentive alignment is high: Latino shop owners want to offer trusted services to their community; they earn referral/commission income. Integration complexity is low: SIM-card distribution point-of-sale plus QR-code activation. Exclusivity potential: high in specific metro areas via exclusive community partner agreements. Activation timeline: 3-6 months to build initial network in 3-5 target metros (Houston, Miami, LA, New York, Chicago).

Dimension 4: Window Structure

Component	Coming of Age	Immigration
Window type	Rolling with seasonal peak (May-August)	Flash to Short (days 1-14 post-arrival)
Peak intent window	June-July (graduation + first job + first apartment)	Days 1-3 (phone plan is among first 3 purchases made in the U.S.)
Intent decay curve	Gradual — after 3 months on an independent plan, inertia sets in; re-evaluation closes	Sharp — after day 14, plan acquired; market closes fast
Decision journey	Awareness (social/community) → Inquiry (WhatsApp recommendation from friend already on carrier) → Decision (store visit or eSIM activation) → Post-decision lock-in (family added within 30 days)	Awareness (airport kiosks, community centers, WhatsApp from family already in U.S.) → Decision (same-day) → Post-decision (adds family plan features over weeks 2-4)

Switching profile summary: The primary interception moment is Coming of Age (Composite 4.27) — predictable, high-volume, seasonally concentrated, community-trust channel accessible. The secondary moment is Immigration (Intent 5.0) — highest urgency, greenfield, but declining volume and higher friction. Gather’s differentiation in both moments is the same: a brand that signals cultural belonging before the first transaction, distributed through trusted community channels, with a plan architecture that anticipates the need to add family members immediately.

Section 3: Executive Brief

Key Insights

- WhatsApp is the product.** For this community, WhatsApp is not a messaging app that a carrier must support — it is the primary communications infrastructure for family, community organizing, and cultural life. A carrier that builds explicitly around WhatsApp (zero-rating, performance guarantees, group-chat features) would be differentiated in a way Metro and Cricket are not.
- The invisible household economic unit.** U.S. Latinos — especially second-generation — manage multi-household, multi-country financial ecosystems. Marisol pays her own plan, her parents’ plans, and sends monthly remittances. The carrier sees one line. The opportunity is to see the whole household network, including across borders, and build plan architecture that serves it.
- “Translated” is not the same as “built for.”** Every incumbent competitor offers Spanish-language service. None have built products from the cultural inside out. The distinction between Spanish translation and cultural authenticity is visible to this community — they describe Metro as “adapted,” not “native.” Gather’s opportunity is to be the first carrier that is native.
- Community-mediated adoption amplifies early wins.** Remitly’s adoption through the family WhatsApp group chat is the model: one trusted recommendation, rapid spread, durable loyalty. If Gather earns the trust of a handful of

Latino community nodes — shop owners, creators, church community leaders — the acquisition flywheel is structurally different from advertising.

5. **The Coming of Age moment is the best interception point.** 700K-1M young Latinos age off family plans annually, concentrated in June-July, excited about independence, and making first-ever carrier decisions. This is the highest-conviction acquisition moment in the segment — more detectable, more emotionally resonant, and more amenable to community-channel activation than the immigration greenfield.

Identity Tensions

1. **Ni de aqui ni de alla — the bicultural in-between.** Second-generation Latinos are fully American and fully Latino simultaneously, and the mainstream market consistently asks them to choose. A carrier that celebrates rather than resolves this tension — that says “both” rather than “pick one” — occupies the only authentic cultural position.
2. **Budget coding vs. aspirational identity.** Spanish-language carrier marketing has been almost exclusively budget-coded in the U.S. market. Upwardly mobile, degree-pursuing, professionally ambitious Latinos resent this deeply. The aspiration is to be treated as a full customer — not a low-income demographic who needs a cheap plan and a Spanish menu.
3. **Community solidarity vs. institutional distrust.** The politically charged immigration environment of 2025-2026 has heightened community awareness of which brands are truly allies versus opportunistic marketers. Trust is harder to earn and more durable once earned. Brands that demonstrate community commitment during adversity, not just during Latinx Heritage Month promotions, earn a category of loyalty no budget discount can replicate.

Top Needs: Stated vs. Unstated

Need Type	Need	Source Factor
Stated	Affordable, unlimited international calling to Mexico and Latin America	Factor 2, 3, 5
Stated	Spanish-language customer service that is truly bilingual, not a budget funnel	Factor 4, 5
Stated	Family plan that makes economic sense for multi-line households	Factor 2, 5
Stated	No contract, no credit check (for new immigrants and recent arrivals)	Factor 2, 4
Unstated	A brand that was built for Latinos, not adapted for them	Factor 1, 3, 4
Unstated	Multi-household plan architecture that treats extended family (including cross-border) as one economic unit	Factor 2, 3
Unstated	Remittance and financial connectivity integration — one ecosystem for managing family money and communication	Factor 2, 3
Unstated	AI-assisted family account management in Spanish — managing parents’ lines without being the family IT help desk	Factor 3, 4
Unstated	A carrier brand that signals cultural pride, not just cultural accommodation	Factor 1, 3

Strategic Recommendations

1. **Enter through the T2-17 new immigrant sub-segment first.** New immigrant Latinos represent the highest-intent switching moment in the entire pipeline (Intent 5.0) and are pure greenfield — no incumbent carrier relationship to displace. The channel is community organizations, immigrant welcome centers, and airport-adjacent distribution. The product requirement is simple: no credit check, Spanish-first service, unlimited calling to Latin America, affordable data. Win here first; the word-of-mouth flywheel spreads to established immigrants (Tier 2) and bicultural second-generation (Tier 3) within 12-18 months.
2. **Build the multi-household plan architecture that no incumbent offers.** The defining unmet structural need is a plan that recognizes the transnational, multi-household reality of Latino family economics. Not a “family plan” in the

carrier sense (4 lines, same address) — a family network plan that can include parents in a different zip code, relatives in Mexico, and a cousin just aging off their parent’s plan. This is a product architecture decision, not a marketing decision, and it requires genuine commitment.

- 3. **Make the Remitly partnership the first non-telco bundle.** Remittances are the single largest recurring financial behavior for this community after rent and groceries. A Gather plan that includes a Remitly discount, zero-fee transfer credit, or integrated in-app remittance capability is the closest thing to a killer feature for this segment. The adoption story for Remitly itself (community recommendation → WhatsApp spread) is the proof of concept.
- 4. **Activate the Coming of Age interception moment.** 700K-1M young Latinos are aging off family plans every year, concentrated in June-July, making first-ever independent plan decisions. Gather should be the brand they encounter at that moment through trusted channels — TikTok Latino creators, quinceañera season partnerships, university Latino organizations (MEChA, LULAC). The first plan decision made independently is exceptionally sticky.
- 5. **Build a WhatsApp referral program as the primary acquisition engine.** The community adoption pattern is established: one trusted recommendation in a WhatsApp group chat reaches 15-40 contacts. Design the referral program explicitly around this mechanic — not email links, not SMS — WhatsApp-native sharing with social proof built in (“Mi prima switched and is saving \$30 a month on Mexico calls”). This lowers CPA while activating the community trust that advertising cannot replicate.

Success Metrics

Metric	Target	Measurement
Latino subscriber acquisition — Year 1	50,000 subscribers across T1-10 personas	Monthly subscriber count by acquisition channel
Community channel conversion rate	25%+ of new subscribers acquired via community channels (Latino retail partners, WhatsApp referral)	Attribution tracking by acquisition source
International calling satisfaction	80%+ satisfaction with Mexico/Latin America calling quality and pricing	In-app NPS survey, monthly
Spanish-language service NLU rating	90%+ of Spanish-language interactions resolved without English escalation	Support ticket language escalation rate
Remittance bundle attachment rate	40% of eligible subscribers attach Remitly partnership within 90 days of activation	Bundle attachment rate tracking
6-month retention rate	85%+ among T2-18 bicultural segment; 75%+ T1 new immigrants (lower due to income/status volatility)	Subscriber cohort retention analysis

Go/No-Go Recommendation

Go, with clear competitive conditions. The opportunity is real: 42M Latino adults, the fastest-growing demographic, with a structural feature gap (international calling, multi-household plan architecture, remittance integration) that incumbents have not closed. Brand-equity potential is high — the community makes brand decisions collectively, and a carrier that earns community trust earns durable loyalty.

The conditions are necessary, not optional: Gather must enter through authentic cultural integration, not Spanish-language translation. The initial product must include unlimited calling to Latin American countries in the base plan — this is not negotiable. The distribution strategy must activate community-trust channels before paid advertising. The T2-17 new immigrant sub-segment is the highest-conviction entry point and should be resourced accordingly.

The competitive risk is real: Metro by T-Mobile and Cricket have genuine community presence and switching friction is their primary moat. Gather wins by being native where they are adapted — but this requires product decisions (multi-household architecture, remittance bundles), not just marketing decisions (Spanglish creative, influencer partnerships). A marketing-only Latino strategy would fail against Metro’s distribution and brand trust. A product-first Latino strategy that distributes through community channels has a genuine path to winning.

Switching profile summary: Primary interception is Coming of Age (Composite 4.27) — 700K-1M/yr, concentrated June-July, community-trust channel accessible via TikTok Latino creators and Latino-owned retail. Secondary interception is Immigration greenfield (Intent 5.0) — 1.5-2M/yr declining, Flash window Days 1-3, distributed through immigrant community centers and airport-adjacent channels. Both moments converge on the same brand requirement: culturally authentic, Spanish-first, international-calling-included.

Appendix: Key Sources

Tier 1 Sources - U.S. Census Bureau. (2024). *Hispanic Population in the United States*. Annual demographic data. - Pew Research Center. (2022, 2023). *Hispanic Trends: Social Media Use, Internet Access, Language Preferences*. - U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). *American Community Survey: Income, Household Size, Educational Attainment*. - USCIS. (2024). *Naturalization Statistics*. Annual report. - DHS. (2024). *Yearbook of Immigration Statistics*. Department of Homeland Security. - National Center for Education

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Tier 2 Sources - Latino Donor Collaborative. (2023). *U.S. Latino GDP: A \$2.8 Trillion Economic Report*. - World Bank. (2023). *Remittance Flows Data — United States to Latin America*. - Nielsen. (2022). *World Cup Viewership Report; 2023 Total Audience Report*. - J.D. Power. (2023). *U.S. Wireless Customer Care Study*. - CTIA. (2023). *Wireless Industry Survey: Prepaid Market Data*. - IBISWorld. (2023). *Quinceañera Industry Report; International Calling Market*. - Gallup. (2022). *Discrimination in Consumer Services — Hispanic Experience*. - National Consumer Law Center. (2022). *Limited English Proficiency and Mobile Carrier Disputes*. - Spotify / MRC Data. (2024). *Latin Music Streaming Growth*.